warships and planes in the war and, between them, almost one thousand lives.

A few days after hostilities started, the president of a Latin American country told me that he had received a tip from his ambassador in Buenos Aires that the British were preparing to attack military bases on the mainland of Argentina. This would have substantially escalated the level of combat. Our intelligence community confirmed that preparations for such attacks were under way. I called Margaret Thatcher to say that, while we fully supported Britain's effort to take back the Falklands, we thought it would be dangerous to move the war onto the mainland of South America. Margaret heard me out, but, demonstrating the iron will for which she is famous, she stood firm. I couldn't persuade her to make a commitment not to invade, and for several days we waited for a nighttime attack by British planes on the mainland—one that never came.

In late May, I called Margaret again, this time to suggest a possible settlement that stopped short of Britain scoring a complete victory over Argentina. A total victory was certain to topple Argentina's government, and some of our people believed that this might lead to violence and chaos that would be exploited by leftist guerrillas. But she told me too many British lives had already been lost for Britain to withdraw without total victory, and she convinced me. I understood what she meant.

Before long, British troops reclaimed the Falklands from the over-matched Argentinean forces. President Galtieri was ousted as head of the junta, and the following year democracy came to Argentina with the election of Raúl Alfonsín as president.

Margaret Thatcher, I think, had no choice but to stand up to the generals who cynically squandered the lives of young Argentineans solely to prolong the life of a corrupt and iron-fisted totalitarian government. She did so, I believe, not